



Also, the 'Settings' application has gained four new configuration panels.

According to reports, a few tweaks have also been done to the GNOME's file manager, the Web browser and the 'Contacts' and 'Documents' applications. GNOME 3.8 is the first major version of the desktop since GNOME 3.6 was released last year in September. This

version has also done away with Fallback Mode for systems without hardware accelerated graphics, and has instead introduced a new Classic Mode; where hardware accelerated graphics are not available, GNOME now uses *llvmpipe*.

An open source alternative to Google Docs

If you are on the look out for document/office software like Google Docs, Microsoft Office and LibreOffice, you're in luck. OX Document, from the stable of Open Xchange, which is known for setting up a Microsoft Exchange alternative, is about to arrive.



According to reports, OX Document is still in its initial development phase and the company has released a demo-version of OX Text, its word processor.

OX Text will be capable of editing content from Microsoft Word, OpenOffice and LibreOffice. The company's CEO has also claimed that OX Text can retain the entire Word document content and edit

about 80 per cent of a Word file's content.

Apart from the convenience of editing anywhere and everything, OX Text will also enable multiple users to view and edit documents simultaneously.

VDR Linux video recorder version 2 released

Linux users have now been offered the second version of the Video Disk Recorder (VDR) released by author Klaus Schmidinger. The new video software comes with full HDTV support.

According to a report, the images from TV are generally processed either by a plug-in using the graphics card or by a DVB card's hardware decoder. The recorder's HD image rendering function is currently supported by TechnoTrend's S2 6400 DVB card only.

The HDTV enhancement has made Schmidinger change the recording format from PES (Packetised Elementary Stream) to TS (Transport Stream); however, the new VDR can still play back old recordings as well.

VDR 2.0 supports Satellite Channel Routing (SCR), which enables multiple receivers to be operated through one cable.

The user interface has also been revamped.



The on-screen display (OSD) offers full-screen HD and TrueColor support, which aids the rendering of images more efficiently.

The new LCARS standard skin is said to be a rendition of the control panels from the Star Trek franchise. The latest version needs DVB drivers that support at least version 5.3 of the DVB API, which means version 3.0 or newer of the Linux kernel or the external DVB drivers from linuxTV.org. The VDR 2.0 comes with additional plug-ins to add more functions to the recorder.

Novell advances mobility portfolio with two additions to Novell ZENworks Product Suite

Novell has announced the release of ZENworks Application Virtualisation 10 and ZENworks Mobile Management (ZMM) 2.7, adding to Novell's mobility portfolio and meeting the productivity and security needs of today's device-saturated businesses. Both releases further equip organisations with the resources and technology to manage growing enterprise application needs, as well as manage employees' needs when working from multiple devices.

Today's business environment demands IT staff to stay one step ahead of the mobile workforce. These latest releases help accomplish this by addressing pressing mobility trends such as Bring Your Own Device (BYOD), as well as traditional enterprise pain points like application management.

ZENworks Application Virtualisation 10 allows users to get virtual versions of their Windows applications where they need them. Through the click-and-go convenience of secure Web portals, users get exactly what they need, when they need it, from any Windows laptop or desktop, regardless of location. This enables IT departments to ensure that users are authorised to access the appropriate applications; they can track consumption of virtualised applications to help organisations ensure they optimise their acquisition of software licences.

ZENworks Mobile Management 2.7 introduces the ability to assign policies to entire Lightweight Directory Access Protocol (LDAP) groups simultaneously, eliminating the tedious and time-consuming task of applying a new policy to each, individually.